

» INDIAN PLAYGROUND

Rajputana Royals crowned champion of the inaugural Archery Premier League



The inaugural Archery Premier League (APL) final at the Yamuna Sports Complex in New Delhi on October 12, between Rajputana Royals and Prithviraaj Yodhas produced an edge-of-the-seat thriller. Royals, trailing by two points at one juncture in the summit clash, stormed back to win 5-4 in a shoot-off.

Royals, which had dominated the competition since the opening day, having gone undefeated for the first week, found itself in the soup early on after Gatha Anandrao Khadake's upgraded arrow saw Yodhas take the first set.

Royals, however, pulled level soon, with recurvers Ankita Bhakat and Mete Gazoz of Turkey starring with timely 10s.

The third set witnessed a historic moment as Yodhas delivered a perfect 80, a first in the competition. However, with only a 9 required to seal the championship in the final set, Mexican Matias Grande erred and hit an 8.

Ojas Deotale and Brit Ella Gibson, two of Royals' most consistent compound archers, made the most of the opportunity and hit the target in the tie-breaker, while none of the four Yodhas, probably still shaken by what had transpired only moments earlier, could find the yellow dot.

The 11-day-long action had featured 36 Indian and 12 top foreign archers, who had been slotted into six franchises.

SANTADEEP DEY



Triumphant: Olympics champion Mete Gazoz of Turkey after leading his franchise Rajputana Royals to victory in the inaugural Archery Premier League in New Delhi. PTI

SPORTOON

